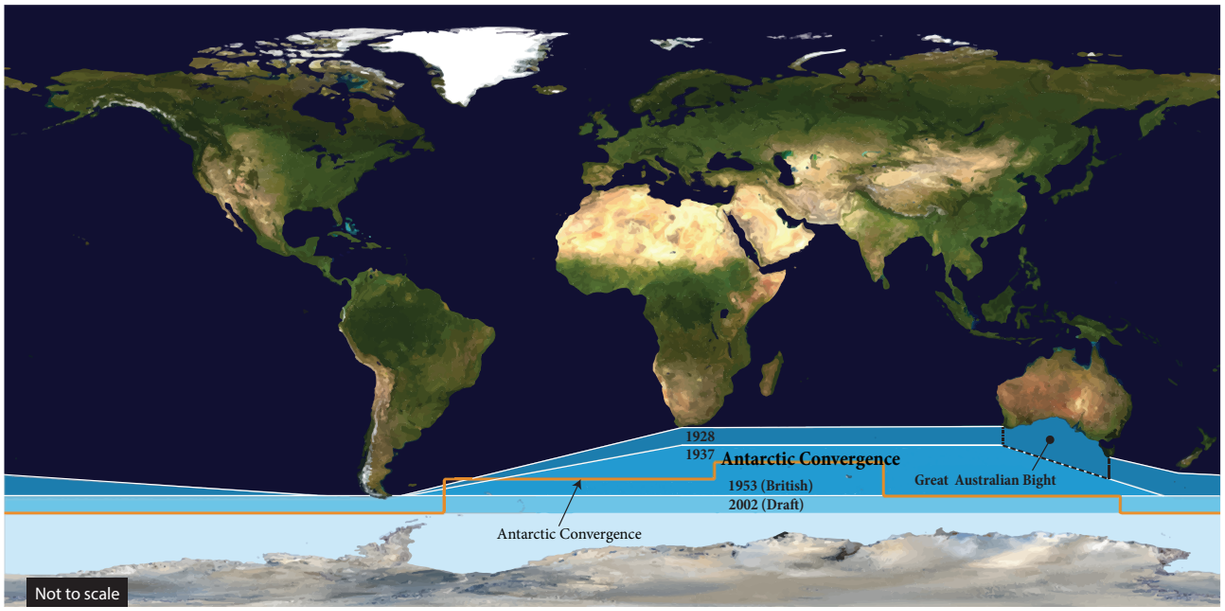


Figure 5.4 Extension of Southern Ocean

5. **The Arctic ocean**

The Arctic Ocean is shallower and smaller than the other four oceans. It is completely surrounded by Eurasia and North America. It is covered by ice completely in winter. The Arctic Ocean's surface temperature and salinity vary seasonally as the ice cover melts and freezes alternatively. Its salinity is the lowest on an average of the five major oceans. Bering Strait connects the Arctic Ocean with the Pacific Ocean while the Greenland Sea and the Labrador Sea connects it with the Atlantic. The deepest point is Litke Deep in the Eurasian Basin, at 5,450 m.

Fact File

The International Hydrographic Organization (IHO) is the inter-governmental organisation that surveys and produces charts for the world's seas, oceans and navigable waters.

5.7 Maritime zones

The low-tide line forms the base line for marking maritime zones. Water landward of the baseline in defined as **internal waters** over which the state has complete sovereignty. A country's **territorial sea** extends up to 12 nautical miles (22.2 km) from its baseline (Figure 5.5). The **contiguous zone** is a zone of water extending from the outer edge of the territorial sea up to 24 nautical miles (44.4 km) from the baseline.

An **Exclusive Economic Zone** (EEZ) extends from the base line to a maximum of 200 nautical miles (370.4 km). A coastal nation has control of all economic resources within its exclusive economic zone, including fishing, mining and oil exploration. Everything beyond EEZ is called **International Waters or the High Seas**. No nation has sovereign rights over this area.

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